

Touching Sound

A tactile and sonic journey through suit symbol

Touching Sound

Touching Sound is an interactive installation created in collaboration with Musée de Jeux, a designer, and artists from fine art and engineering backgrounds. The project explores tactility and sound beyond sight, using sensory play to reimagine the gestures of handling suit cards. Designed for children and families visiting the museum, it offers a playful journey through the history of suit symbols.

Visitors place their hand on a round table whose 3D-printed surface features varied tactile textures. Their movements trigger sounds and historical suit visuals in real time. Using Mediapipe for hand detection and p5.js for creative coding, each gesture becomes a sensory dialogue between touch, sound, and imagery, inviting participants to experience the unseen rhythms of play.

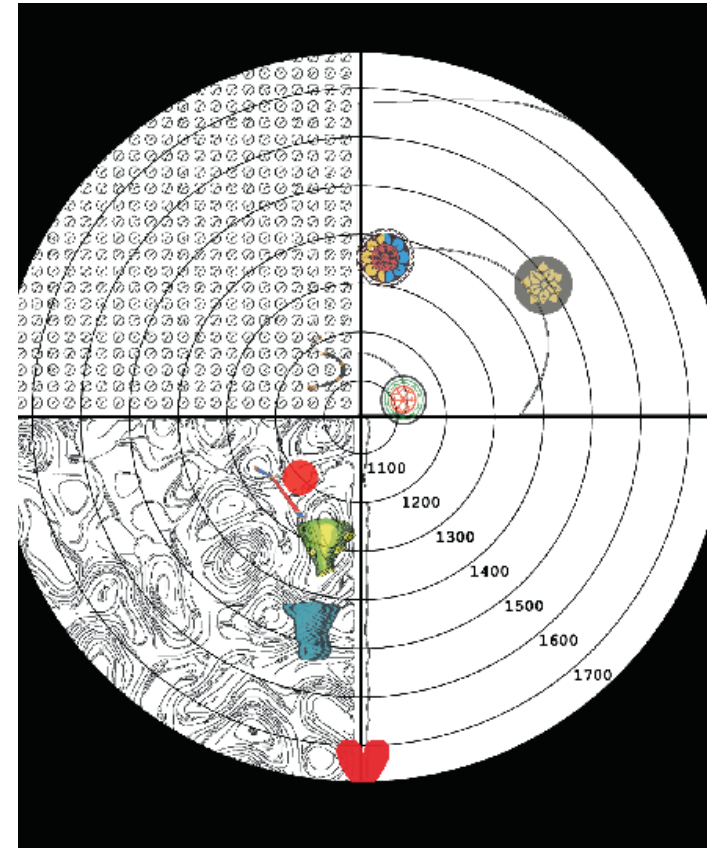
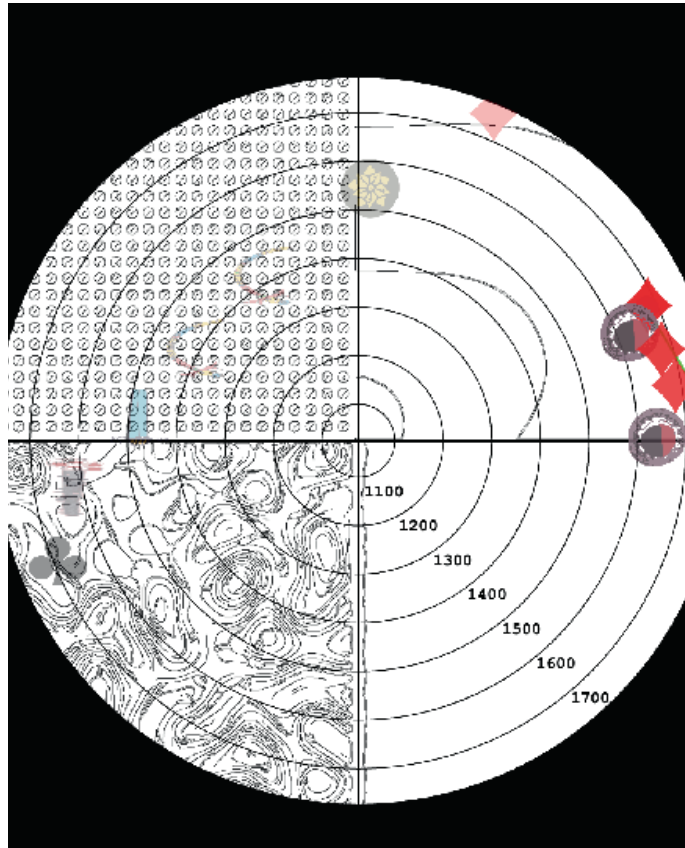
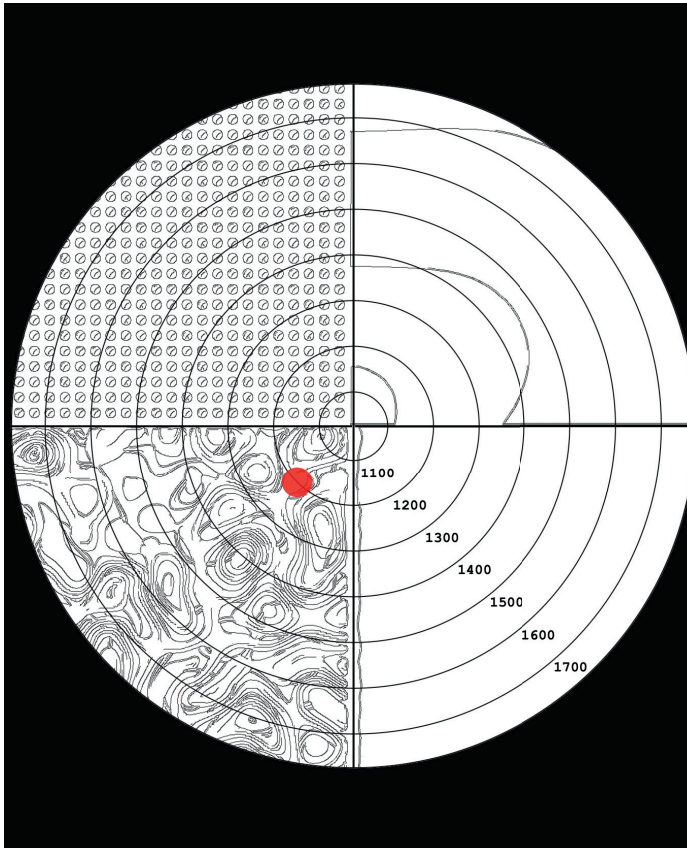
Option a. Project key visual portrait

Option b. Project key visual landscape

Additional project visuals - optional

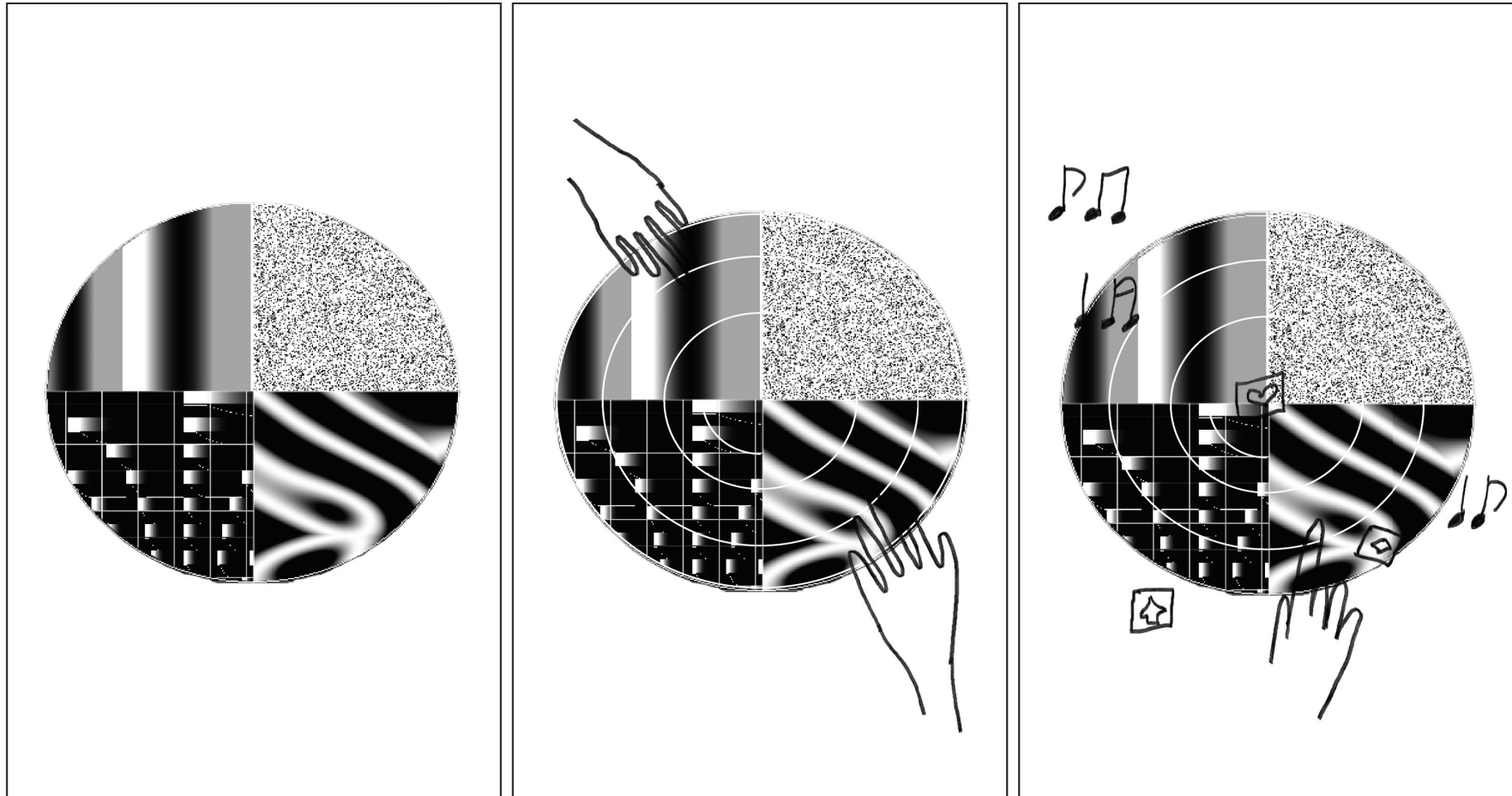
Additional project visuals - optional

The Interface - Key visuals



User Journey

Background visuals and hand movement videos are projected onto the table to guide users when no other visuals are displayed. By moving their hands on the table, users navigate the map, triggering sound and visual feedback via MediaPipe. The installation supports two to four hands, offering a playful, interactive way to explore the historical meanings of French suit card symbols.



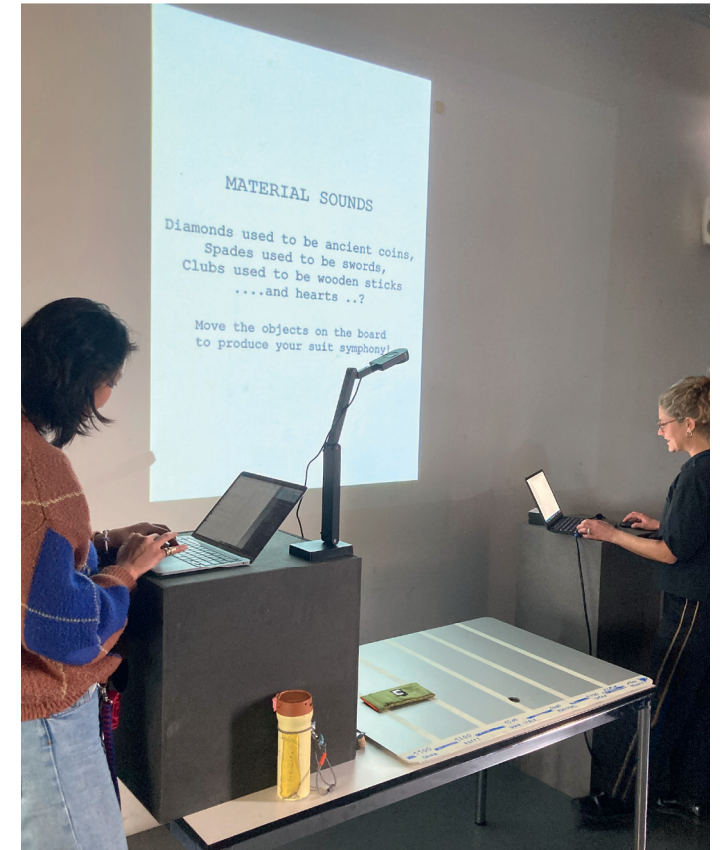
Field observations

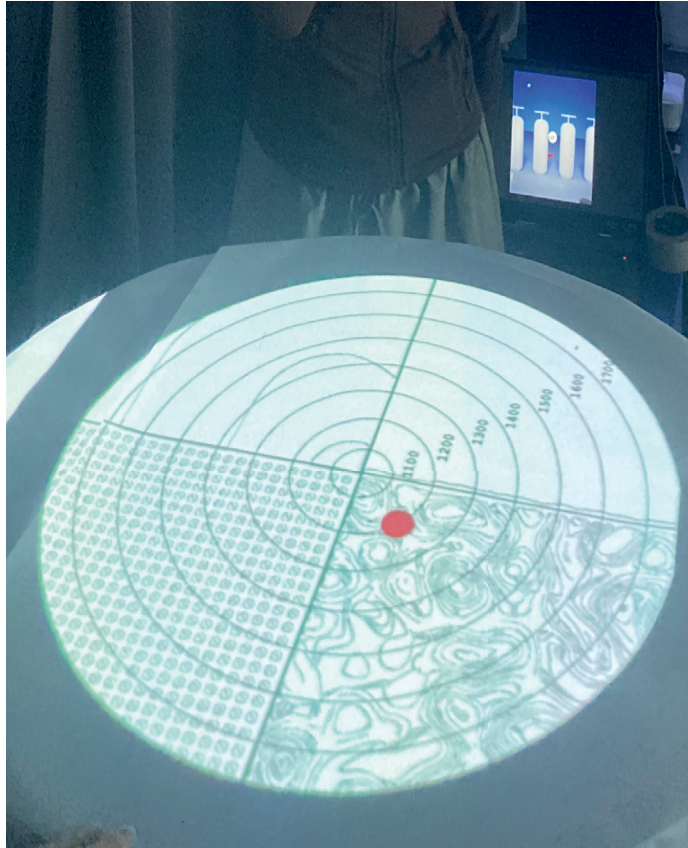
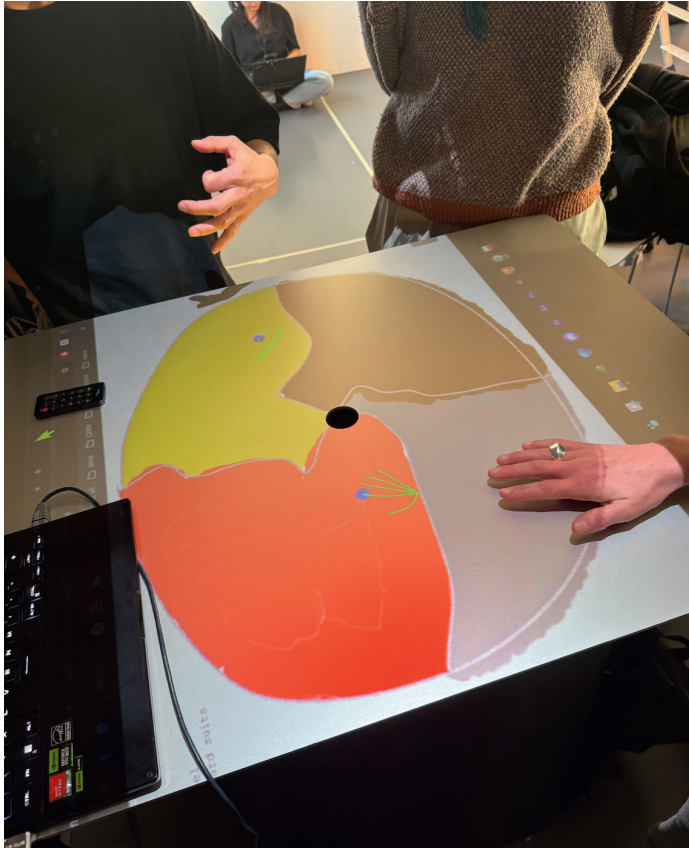
Before starting the project, the three of us were most interested in how to transform historical suit cards into a sensory, playable installation. Observing the museum's audience of children and families led us to focus on touch, sound, and the diverse history of suit symbols.



User Tests

Through mid-term presentations, we explored tactile qualities, forms, and techniques, including ArUco marker-based sound interactions. We researched the historical context of French suit cards and faced challenges in guiding users, prompting iterative refinements. Applying MediaPipe hand detection, we developed our final prototype.

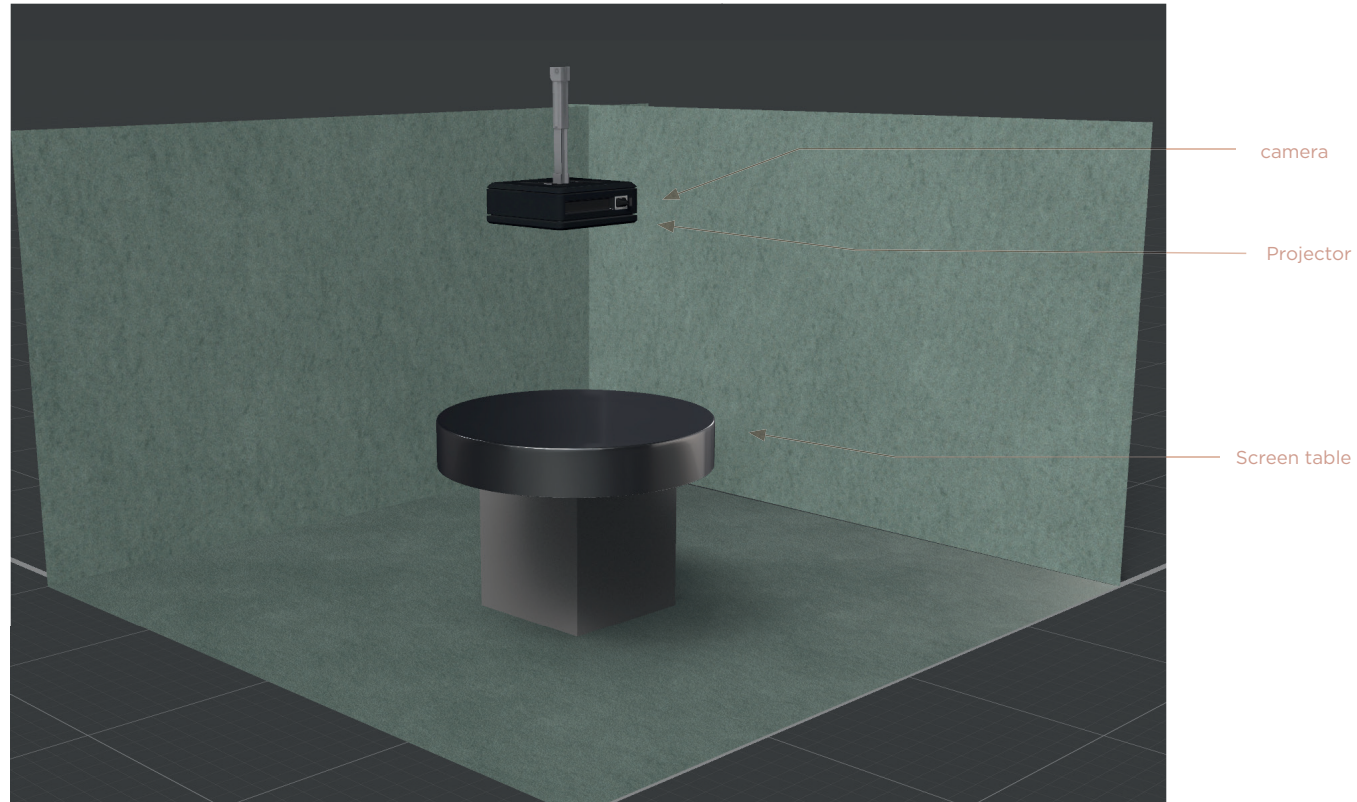




Scenography



Spatial diagram



Technical diagram

